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June 20, 1967
SUPERSEDING
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July 19, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLEANER, VACUUM, ELECTRIC (PORTABLE, BACK-PACK)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers electrically operated, portable, back-pack vacuum cleaners.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and sizes. Vacuum cleaners covered by this specification shall be of one type and of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 350 watt input (min.).
Size 2 - 600 watt input (min.).
Size 3 - 650 watt input (min.).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

J-C-580 - Cord, Flexible, and Wire, Fixture, (Electrical, 0 - to 600-Volt Service).
W-C-596 - Connector, Plug, Electrical; Connector, Receptacle, Electrical.
CC-M-636 - Motor, Alternating-Current, (Fractional Horsepower).
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

MIL-E-16298 - Electric Machines Having Rotating Parts and Associated Repair Parts: Packaging of.

MIL-I-43121 - Interference Reduction for Electric Hand Tools.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Underwriters' Laboratories (UL), Inc. Standard:

UL No. 73 - Motor Operated Appliances.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Underwriters' Laboratories, Inc., 207 East Ohio St., Chicago, Ill., 60611; 1285 Walt Whitman Rd., Melville, LongIsland, N. Y., 11749; or 1655 Scott Blvd., Santa Clara, Calif., 95050.)

U. S. Department of Commerce Standard:

CS225-59-Method of Rating Commercial and Industrial Type Vacuum Cleaners (Portable and Mobile).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Fire and casualty hazards.

3.1.1 Conformance to standards of UL, Inc. Each contractor shall submit to the contracting agency proof that the vacuum cleaners he proposes to supply under this specification conforms to the requirements of the UL, Inc. Std. No. 73. The label or listing with re-examination of UL, Inc. may be accepted as evidence that the vacuum cleaners conform to this requirement.

3.1.2 Data from other laboratories. In lieu of the label, or listing with re-examination, the contractor may submit independent proof, satisfactory to the contracting agency, that the vacuum cleaners conform to the applicable requirements of the published standards, including methods of test of the UL, Inc. Std. No. 73.

3.1.3 Contractor compliance. Compliance with UL, Inc. requirements regarding fire and casualty hazards does not absolve the contractor from complete compliance with the requirements of this specification in order to secure acceptance of his vacuum cleaners.

3.2 Standard product. Each vacuum cleaner furnished under this specification shall be the manufacturer's current standard product except for those modifications or changes required in order to comply with the requirements of this specification. All accessories and components shall be furnished that are normally furnished with the standard product offered commercially.

3.3 Materials. The materials used shall be suitable for the purpose intended and shall be free from defects affecting the appearance or serviceability of the cleaners.

3.4 Construction. Each vacuum cleaner shall be complete, ready to operate, simple in construction, reliable in operation, and constructed so as to be readily disassembled for

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inspection, adjustment, or replacement of parts. Each part of the vacuum cleaner shall be interchangeable with the similar part of any other vacuum cleaner of the same model and size made by the same manufacturer.

3.5 Design. The vacuum cleaners covered by this specification shall be of one type for commercial use in picking up dry material. Cleaners shall be of the portable, back-pack design, using the dry separation method. Dirt pickup shall be accomplished without the use of dirt agitators. Cleaners shall be of the exposed or enclosed separator design and shall be electric motor operated. The vacuum cleaners shall be equipped for air blowing for the purpose of air sweeping. Air blowing shall be through the cleaner hose attached to a fitting on the cleaner. The cleaners shall be equipped with permanently lubricated sealed bearings or be provided with readily accessible means for lubrication.

3.5.1 Illustrations. Vacuum cleaners shall be similar to figure 1. Figure 1 contained herein is descriptive for identification purposes only and is not to be construed as restrictive. Vacuum cleaners otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification shall be equally acceptable.



FIGURE I. Sizes 1, 2, and 3.

3.6 Vacuum cleaner performance.

3.6.1 Air suction. The vacuum cleaner shall conform to the requirements of table I. The suction performance of the cleaners shall be given in terms of inches of water lift.

TABLE I. Requirements for vacuum cleaners

Size	Motor			Suction at end of 5 feet of 1-1/2 inch I.D hose, 1-inch orifice	Net weight without attachments (max.)
	Input (min.)	Duty cycle	Load speed (min.)	Water lift (min.)	
	Watts		R.p.m.	Inches	Pounds
1	350	Continuous	14,000	17	15
2	600	Continuous	18,000	22	20
3	650	Continuous	11,000	30	22

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3.6.2 Air blowing. Conversion from vacuum operation to air blowing operation and back to vacuum operation shall be accomplished without the use of tools. Air blown from the cleaner shall pass through the cleaner filters.

3.7 Vacuum cleaner body. The entire exterior surface of the cleaner body shall be smooth. Ferrous metal parts, except corrosion-resistant metal, shall be either cadmium plated, nickel plated, chromium plated, or primed and suitably coated in accordance with the best commercial practice. A plastic body of high impact strength shall be acceptable.

3.8 Vacuum producer. The vacuum producer shall be enclosed and be of rugged construction and shall function without objection noise or vibration. Surfaces of the im-impeller and air passages shall be constructed so that dirt will not build up on these surfaces to the extent of significantly affecting the flow of air. Means shall be provided to prevent metallic and heavy debris from entering the impeller case of the cleaner.

3.9 Electrical equipment.

3.9.1 Electric motor. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), motors shall be the universal type in accordance with CC-M-636. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the motors shall operate on nominal 115 volt circuits. The motors shall be continuous duty type and shall be designed to operate under full rated load conditions in an ambient temperature of 40°C. without exceeding the allowable temperature rise.

3.9.2 Motor switch. The motor switch shall be of the enclosed quick-make-and-break type and shall be adequately insulated. The motor switch shall be mounted on the vacuum cleaner or on the electric cord within easy reach of the operator. The switch shall conform to the applicable requirements of UL Std. No. 73.

3.9.3 Electric cord assembly. An electric cord assembly consisting of a cord conforming to the applicable requirements of J-C-580 and a plug connector conforming to the applicable requirements of W-C-596 shall be furnished with each cleaner. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the cord shall contain 3 conductors and be of the construction specified in UL No. 73 for commercial vacuum cleaners. The exterior of the cord shall be colored yellow. The cord conductors shall be of an American wire gage (AWG) size sufficient to carry 125 percent of the rated circuit current continuously, but in no case shall the conductors be smaller than AWG size 18. One end of the grounding wire shall be connected to the motor or cleaner frame, and the other end shall be connected to the ground terminal of the connector plug. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the plug connector shall conform to the configuration requirements for style D plugs of W-C-596 and shall be molded as an integral part of the cord or have a detachable cord grip connector fastened to the cord. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the cord shall be 50 feet, plus 3 inches, minus 0 inch in length measured from the plug connector to the point of entrance into the cleaner. When specified (see 6.2),,an adapter plug for connecting the cleaner cord to 2 wire receptacles shall be furnished with each cleaner.

3.10 Attachments. Unless otherwise specified (6.2), the vacuum cleaner shall be provided with the following attachments:

Sizes 1, 2, and 3	
1 bare floor tool.	1 carpet tool.
1 floor handle.	1 extension handle.
1 radiator and crevice tool.	1 round brush tool.
1 hose.	

The dimensional requirements of the vacuum cleaner attachments shall be in accordance with table II.

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TABLE II. Dimensional requirements for attachments

Attachments	Inside diameter	Overall length		Outside diameter	
	(Min.)	(Min.)	(Max.)	(Min.)	(Max.)
	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches
Bare floor tool	1-1/2	12	16	-------	-------
Carpet tool	1-1/2	12	16	-------	-------
Floor handle	1-1/2	48	-------	-------	-------
Extension handle	1-1/2	48	-------	-------	-------
Radiator and crevice tool	1-1/2	9	-------	-------	-------
Round brush tool	1-1/2	-------	-------	3	4
Hose	1-1/2	36	60	-------	-------

3.10.1 Materials and coatings. Vacuum cleaner attachments shall be made of steel, brass, aluminum alloy, or suitable molded plastic, as specified (see 6.2). The entire exposed surface of each ferrous attachment shall have a corrosion-resistant coating. The surfaces of all attachments shall be smooth with corners and edges rounded.

3.10.2 Bare floor tool. The bare floor tool shall be so constructed that when the tool handle is held stationary, the head may be rotated at least 175° around the swivel coupling on the floor handle.

3.10.3 Carpet tool. The carpet tool shall be so constructed that when the tool handle is held stationary, the head may be rotated at least 175° around the swivel coupling on the floor handle.

3.10.4 Floor handle. The floor handle shall be so constructed that the bare floor and carpet tools will be in proper position on the floor when in use and shall allow the tools to swivel at least 175°. When plastic handles are specified (see 3.10.1), the plastic shall be of the high impact strength type. The outside surface of the floor handle shall be smoothly finished. The inside surface of the handle shall withstand abrasion from dirt and particles passing through the handle.

3.10.5 Extension handle. The extension handle shall conform to the material, finish, and abrasion requirements of 3.10.4.

3.10.6 Radiator and crevice tool. The radiator and crevice tool shall conform to the requirements of 3.10.1.

3.10.7 Round brush tool. The round brush tool shall conform to the requirements of 3.10.1 and in addition, the brush portion of the tool shall be made of soft bristles or other suitable fibrous material. The working length of the bristles shall be one inch, minimum.

3.10.8 Hose. The hose shall be made of flexible and durable rubber or plastic, reinforced by a helical spring steel wire, throughout the entire length of the hose. The hose end connections shall be permanently attached and shall be made of metal or other suitable material. The connections shall not leak air. The exterior of the hose covering shall be nonmarking.

3.10.8.1 Hose strength. The hose shall be capable of sustaining a compressive load of 200 pounds perpendicular to its longitudinal axis without causing rupture of the hose or permanent deformation greater then 1/16 inch.

3.10.9 Couplings. The coupling shall be of a type which shall not require the use of tools for effective locking and unlocking. The couplings shall not leak air.

3.10.9.1 Coupling strength. The couplings, when locked to the hose and any tool, shall be capable of sustaining a tensile load of 25 pounds applied in an axial direction without causing rupture or permanent deformation of the hose or couplings, air leaks, or changes in the locking and unlocking characteristics of the couplings.

3.11 Carrying harness. A carrying harness shall be provided for carrying the vacuum cleaner on the operator's back with the weight of the cleaner supported on the operator's shoulders. The harness shall be of sufficient strength to support the cleaner and shall be provided with suitable body straps to prevent the cleaner from shifting or swinging. The harness shall contain padding, where necessary, in order to eliminate discomfort to the operator. The design of the harness shall be such that with the cleaner attached, the operator can put it on and take it off without assistance. The cleaner shall be easily attached to and removed from the harness.

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3.12 Radio-interference suppression. When specified (see 6.2), the vacuum cleaners shall be radio-interference suppressed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-I-43121.

3.13 Identification marking.

3.13.1 Civil agencies. Each vacuum cleaner shall be plainly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's designation and either his name or a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. Complete data for the motor including the voltage, horsepower, watts input, or amperage shall be marked either on the motor nameplate or at some other visible place on the vacuum cleaner.

3.13.2 Military agencies. Each vacuum cleaner shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.14 Instruction manual and repair parts list. One copy of the manufacturer's manual of instructions for operation and maintenance and a list of repair parts shall be furnished with each vacuum cleaner. The repair parts list shall include the manufacturer's part number for each part, description of parts, quantity of each part required, and the cost of parts prevailing at the time of contract award. Repair parts for different model vacuum cleaners shall not have the same part number unless the parts are interchangeable. The repair parts list may be included in the instruction manual.

3.15 Workmanship. The vacuum cleaners shall be free from external sharp or rough edges and defects which may impair their serviceability and durability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsiblity for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, the contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 End item inspection. All vacuum cleaners of the same size, including the attachments (see 3.10), and carrying harness (see 3.11), for each cleaner, offered for acceptance at one time shall constitute a lot for the purpose of inspection. The sample unit for these inspections shall be one completely fabricated vacuum cleaner with its attachments and carrying harness.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. Each sample unit shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Material	Any component or material not as specified	X	
	Any component or accessory missing or malformed	X	
Construction and Workmanship	Any design or construction feature not as specified	X	
	Exposed ferrous metal part of body not plated as specified		X
Workmanship	Plating or corrosion-resistant coating not uniform and complete over entire exposed area		X

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TABLE III. Classification of defects (Cont'd.)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Workmanship (Cont'd.)	Exterior surface of cleaner body, handle, or attachment not smooth; corner or edge of attachment not rounded	X	
	Any burr or rough edge which may cause personal injury	X	
	Coupling, locking device, or part not secure	X	
	Any detachable accessory not easily detached by hand		X
	Any dent, scratch, tear, or other defect in body or attachment affecting appearance		X
	Any dent, tear, or other defect in body or attachment affecting serviceability	X	
	Any part of assembly of body or accessory out of alignment	X	
	Carrying harness not securely attached; uncomfortable to wear	X	
Identification marking	Missing, incomplete, not legible		X
Instruction manual	Missing, incomplete, not legible	X	
Repair parts list	Missing, incomplete, not legible	X	

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined to determine compliance with dimensional requirements. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 Testing.

4.2.2.3.1 Air performance samples. One sample vacuum cleaner selected from each lot (see 4.2.2), shall be tested in accordance with 4.3.1 and 4.3.2. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.2.3.2 Test samples. Tests shall be performed in accordance with 4.3.3 through 4.3.6 and when applicable, 4.3.7 (see 3.12); on samples selected from each lot (see 4.2.2). The inspection level shall be 5.2 with an AQL of 2.5 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Air suction performance. Vacuum cleaners shall be tested for air suction performance in accordance with CS225-59 to determine conformance to 3.6.1. A 5-foot length of 1-1/2 inch inside diameter hose and a 1-inch diameter orifice shall be used in conjunction with the testing chamber.

4.3.2 Air blowing performance. The vacuum cleaner shall be converted from vacuum operation to air blowing operation and back to vacuum operation to determine conformance to 3.6.2.

4.3.3 Motor switch test. The vacuum cleaner motor switch shall be tested in accordance with the applicable provisions of UL Std. No. 73 to determine conformance to 3.9.2.

4.3.4 Hose strength. The hose shall be subjected to a compressive load test to determine conformance to 3.10.8.1. A compressive load of 200 pounds shall be applied to any portion of the hose by means of two parallel surfaces having a length of 3 inches parallel to the axis of the hose. The load shall be applied for 2 minutes and then released.

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4.3.5 Coupling strength. Couplings for the hose and tools shall be tested for strength to determine conformance to 3.10.9.1. A tensile axial load of 25 pounds shall be applied to the engaged cleaner hose and tools for 2 minutes and then released.

4.3.6 Carrying harness test. The carrying harness shall be tested to determine conformance to 3.11. With the harness attached to a vacuum cleaner, an operator shall put the harness on himself without assistance. The operator shall walk and assume various positions required in cleaning operations. The operator shall observe whether or not the harness meets the specified requirements. With the cleaner attached, the operator shall remove the harness without assistance.

4.3.7 Radio-interference suppression test. When applicable, the vacuum cleaners shall be tested to determine compliance with 3.12.

4.4 Examination of preparation fro delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking as required by section 5 are complied with. Defects shall be scored as specified in table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Markings	Missing, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: incomplete or insecure preservation, cushioning, or packaging, as applicable (see MIL-P-116 and MIL-E-16298); incomplete or insecure closure of case liner; insufficient or insecure stapling, nailing, strapping, or tape banding; bracing or blocking inadequate, missing, or insecure; bolts and closures improperly affixed; components of the end item improperly secured; bulging or distortion of shipping container.
Weight	Gross weight exceeds requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), vacuum cleaners, attachments, accessories, and repair parts shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method III. When specified (see 6.2), complete vacuum cleaners shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-E-16298. Technical publications shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.2 Level C. The complete vacuum cleaner shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the industry's standard practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One or more complete vacuum cleaners of the same size shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant; or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight of the triple-wall box or the wood box shall not exceed 200 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 box shall not exceed the specification weight limitations.

5.2.2 Level B. One or more complete vacuum cleaners of the same size shall be packed in fiberboard shipping containers conforming to class domestic of PPP-B-636. Containers shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the requirements of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

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5.2.3 Level C. The complete vacuum cleaners shall be packed to afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier's commercial practice shall be acceptable when it fulfills these requirements.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The vacuum cleaners covered by this specification are intended for use in cleaning congested areas, stairways, and other areas where maximum mobility of cleaning equipment is required.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Size vacuum cleaner required (see 1.2.1).

(c) Type motor required if different from 3.9.1.

(d) Motor voltage if different from 3.9.1.

(e) Number of conductors in electric cord if different from 3.9.3.

(f) Style connector plug if different from 3.9.3.

(g) Length of electric cord if different from 3.9.3.

(h) When an adapter plug is required (see 3.9.3).

(i) Attachments required if different from 3.10.

(j) Materials from which attachments shall be made (see 3.10.1).

(k) When vacuum cleaners shall be equipped for radio-interference suppression (see 3.12).

(l) Levels of preservation, packaging, and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(m) Preservation if different from 5.1.1.

(n) When complete vacuum cleaners shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-E-16298 (see 5.1.1).

(o) Special marking when required (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2).

6.3 Level B preservation and packaging for civil agency procurements. When level B preservation and packaging is specified for civil agency procurement the requirements of 5.1.1 shall apply.

MILITARY INTEREST:

CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - Docks
Air Force - MOA

Review activities:

Army - GL, MD, MO, EL
Air Force - MOA

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

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User activity:

Navy - Docks

Military coordinating activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCY INTEREST:

VA

U. S. Government Printing Office: 1967

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